

Play The Itsy Bitsy Spider

Repeat this simple rhyme as you walk your fingers up and down each of your baby's arms in turn and end with a gentle tickle and big smile. She will love to watch your face, soon grow accustomed to the repetitive sounds, and begin to express her delight at the game:

"The itsy bitsy spider
Climbed up the water spout.
Down came the rain,
And washed the spider out.
Out came the sun,
And dried up all the rain,
So the itsy bitsy spider
Climbed up the spout again!"



Where are you?

Lie on your back on the bed or floor and lay your baby on her front on your chest with your hands around her middle. Hold your head up so you can see your baby. Call her name and raise her body up slightly to encourage her to lift her head a little to see you. Repeat a couple more times, praising her if she looks at you. Raising her head is the first movement she learns to control, and is necessary for the next stage of her motor development.